



# India & Sudan: Building Bridges, Expanding Opportunities, Shaping a Shared Future

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## FOREWORD

Sudan occupies a distinctive and, in many respects, underexplored position within Africa's economic landscape. Endowed with vast arable land, significant mineral and livestock resources, and a strategic location linking the Red Sea, the Sahel and the wider East African region, the country holds long-term potential across agriculture, mining, energy and trade-linked infrastructure. At the same time, prolonged conflict, institutional disruption and infrastructure gaps have constrained the pace and predictability of economic activity, shaping a landscape where opportunity and risk sit closely together, and where rebuilding and diversification will define the years ahead.

India and Sudan share a longstanding relationship rooted in historical ties, developmental cooperation and an expanding agenda of engagement across agriculture, mining, healthcare, education and skills, infrastructure, and trade. Trade has historically spanned pharmaceuticals, agricultural inputs, machinery, textiles and consumer goods moving from India, against Sudanese exports of oilseeds, gum Arabic, livestock products and select minerals. While the ongoing conflict has disrupted trade volumes, logistics and normal business operations, the underlying complementarities between the two economies remain intact India's manufacturing and pharmaceutical strength alongside Sudan's agricultural and resource base continue to offer a durable basis for engagement once conditions permit fuller-scale activity. This paper takes care to present these linkages as they stand today, distinguishing established patterns from areas of future potential.

Looking ahead, the paper outlines a practical set of initiatives through which CCI India can support Indian businesses in staying engaged with Sudan in a manner appropriate to current conditions whether through knowledge sharing, institutional dialogue with the Embassy of Sudan in India, or early-stage relationship building with Sudanese counterparts that can be scaled as stability improves. This Knowledge Paper examines, in a structured and evidence-based manner, the current state of Sudan's economy, its major sectors, and the opportunities and constraints shaping India-Sudan economic engagement, serving as a reference for CCI India's engagement with the Embassy, Sudanese stakeholders, and Indian companies assessing the market.




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# SUDAN

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“ Explore ancient pyramids and cultural depth along the Nile.



## Introduction

Sudan is a large North-African country with strategic position and abundant resources (gold 70% of exports), but the April 2023 civil conflict has severely disrupted economic activity, government finances, and bilateral trade with India. Political stabilization could enable cooperation in mining, agri-processing, and renewable energy.

India and Sudan maintain an established diplomatic relationship, with Sudan operating a resident embassy in New Delhi. This mission serves as the primary channel for political dialogue, trade facilitation, and consular services between the two nations.

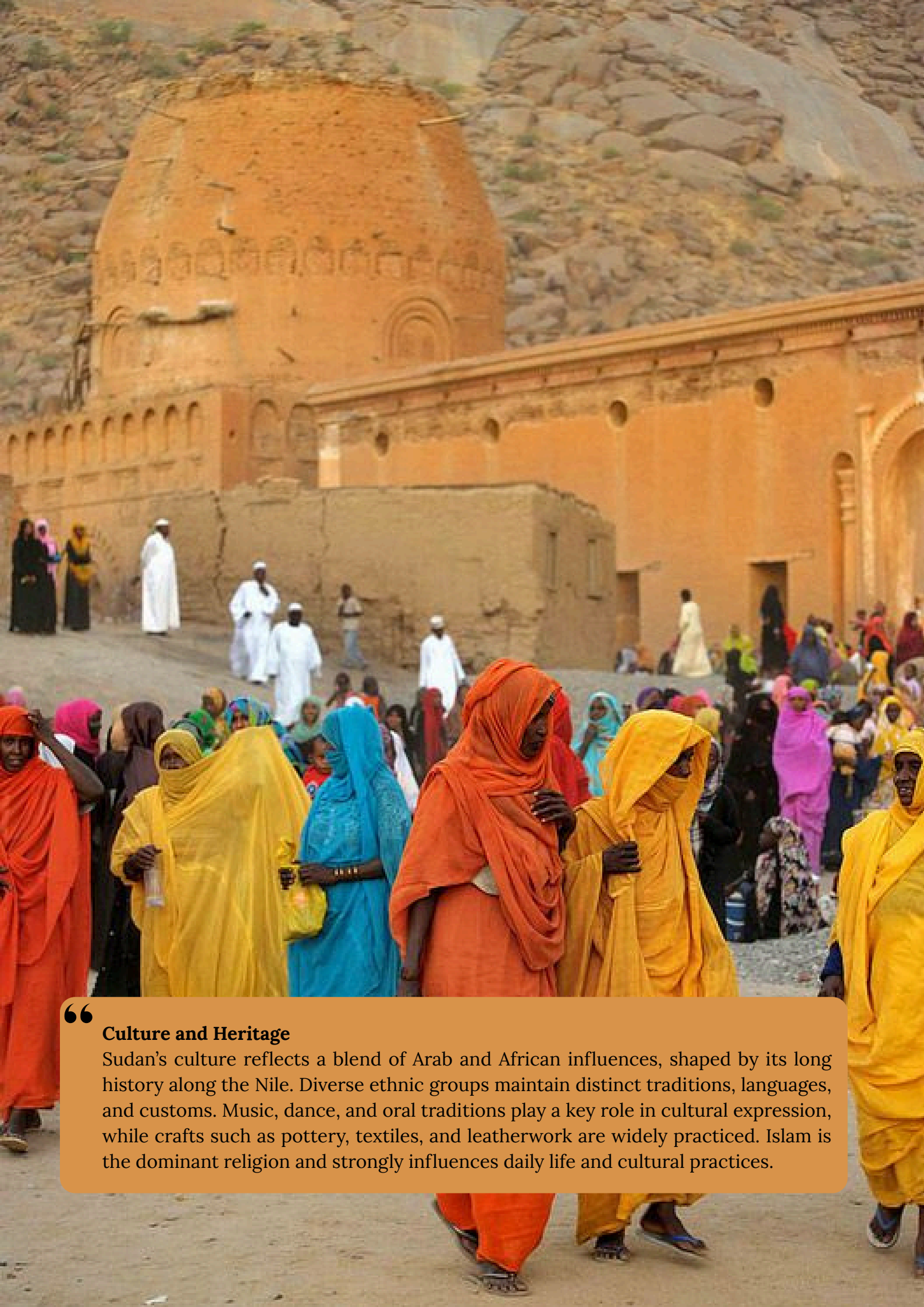
## Basic Facts & Demographics

Sudan is a republic with its capital at Khartoum. Current demographic estimates place the population at approximately 51.7 million, making it one of Africa's most populous countries, though figures remain contested due to the ongoing civil conflict that began in 2023. The national currency is the Sudanese Pound (SDG).

Sudan's substantial young population and arable land reserves have historically shaped domestic-market potential and labor availability, although persistent instability currently constrains economic growth and reliable demographic census data.

## Embassy Of Sudan In India — Role & Functions

The Embassy of the Republic of Sudan in New Delhi executes core diplomatic functions: it advances bilateral political dialogue, facilitates trade and investment flows, organizes business delegations, supports cultural and academic exchanges, and delivers consular services to Sudanese citizens and Indian visa applicants. The mission serves as a practical contact point for Indian firms exploring procurement, supply contracts, or project opportunities in Sudan—including energy, agricultural inputs, and mineral sectors—and for Sudanese students, investors, and travelers engaging with India.



“

### **Culture and Heritage**

Sudan's culture reflects a blend of Arab and African influences, shaped by its long history along the Nile. Diverse ethnic groups maintain distinct traditions, languages, and customs. Music, dance, and oral traditions play a key role in cultural expression, while crafts such as pottery, textiles, and leatherwork are widely practiced. Islam is the dominant religion and strongly influences daily life and cultural practices.

## **Economy — GDP, Structure & Recent Performance**

Sudan's economy is natural-resource-intensive, historically dominated by oil (pre-2011), gold mining, and agriculture, with pre-conflict nominal GDP estimates ranging \$30–50 billion. However, the economy has contracted dramatically since the April 2023 civil conflict, with the World Bank documenting severe GDP declines, government finance disruptions, currency devaluation, and infrastructure damage that weakens agricultural production and mineral extraction. These conditions materially constrain Sudan's import capacity, reduce government contracting, elevate investor risk significantly, and disrupt bilateral trade flows with India, while recovery timelines remain uncertain pending political stabilization



## **Economic & Strategic Areas Of Cooperation**

Historically, Practical Cooperation Areas Between India And Sudan Have Included Agricultural Commodities (Sesame, Groundnuts), Pharmaceuticals, Petroleum & Petroleum Products, Engineering Goods, And Technical Cooperation/Itec Programmes. India Has Been A Supplier Of Affordable Medicines, Machinery And Foodstuffs, While Sudan Has Supplied Oil, Minerals And Agricultural Raw Materials. Potential Future Cooperation (Contingent On Stability) Could Expand Into Mining/ Gold Value-Chains, Agri-Processing, Renewable Energy And Selective Infrastructure Projects — Areas Where Indian Firms Have Competitive Experience.

## **Conclusion & Recommendations**

Sudan is a resource-rich partner for India with historical commercial ties and a resident embassy in New Delhi facilitating bilateral contacts. However, the ongoing conflict since 2023 has produced severe humanitarian and macroeconomic shocks, interrupted trade channels, and sharply increased commercial and political risk.

For policy-grade reporting, cite up-to-date multilateral data (UN/World Bank), official embassy briefs, and ComTrade/Trading Economics for trade figures. Recommended short-term actions for stakeholders: prioritize trade in low-touch goods (pharma, packaged food, engineering spares); avoid large green-field investments until stability returns; and use embassies and trade promotion bodies for real-time intelligence and payment guarantees.

# 1. Country Profile

A business oriented profile of the Republic of Sudan for Indian industry, investors and institutional stakeholders. Sudan is Africa's third largest country by land area and occupies a strategically important position linking Sub Saharan Africa, North Africa, the Nile Basin and the Red Sea/Middle East corridor. The country has been in a state of civil conflict since April 2023, and the snapshot below distinguishes long standing structural facts (geography, resources) from economic indicators that have shifted materially because of the conflict.

For Indian industry, Sudan represents a market with significant underlying economic potential despite the severe constraints created by the ongoing conflict. Its large agricultural base, natural resources, Red Sea access and position within regional trade routes provide a foundation for longer term commercial engagement. At the same time, businesses must distinguish between opportunities that can be pursued under current conditions and those that are more appropriately considered as part of Sudan's medium to long term recovery and reconstruction.

**Table: Sudan Country Snapshot**

| Parameter                | Detail                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Official Name            | Republic of the Sudan                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Capital                  | Khartoum (de jure); Port Sudan has functioned as the interim seat of government and diplomatic activity since 2023 due to the conflict)                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Population               | 48.1 million (2023, World Bank/UN base estimate); subsequent estimates for 2025 range c. 50–52 million depending on methodology and displacement adjustments figures are unusually volatile due to conflict driven displacement and should be treated as indicative.                                             |
| Area                     | 1,886,068 sq. km 3rd largest country in Africa                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Currency                 | Sudanese Pound (SDG)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Official Languages       | Arabic and English                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Political Structure      | Transitional governance under military led authorities amid ongoing conflict between the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) and the Rapid Support Forces (RSF); a Transitional Prime Minister (Kamil El Tayeb Idris, as of late 2025) heads a transitional civilian administration aligned with the SAF led authorities |
| Administrative Divisions | 18 states (wilayat)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

| Parameter                | Detail                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Major Cities             | Khartoum, Omdurman, Khartoum North (Bahri), Port Sudan, Kassala, El Obeid, Nyala, Wad Madani, Atbara                                                                         |
| Geographic Location      | North East Africa; bordered by Egypt, Libya, Chad, Central African Republic, South Sudan, Ethiopia and Eritrea, with a Red Sea coastline                                     |
| Major Port               | Port Sudan Sudan's principal seaport on the Red Sea and its main gateway for external trade                                                                                  |
| Key Land Borders         | Egypt (north), Libya (north west), Chad (west), Central African Republic (south west), South Sudan (south), Ethiopia (south east), Eritrea (east)                            |
| Natural Resources        | Gold and other minerals, petroleum, arable land, livestock, gum Arabic, fisheries, forestry resources                                                                        |
| Trade/Regional Groupings | African Union (AU), African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA signed), Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa (COMESA), Arab League, World Trade Organization (WTO) |

## 1.1 Geography

Sudan sits at the crossroads of Sub Saharan Africa, North Africa and the Arabian Peninsula, with direct access to the Red Sea one of the world's busiest maritime trade corridors linking the Indian Ocean to the Mediterranean via the Suez Canal. This geography gives Sudan a structural relevance for India that goes beyond bilateral trade volumes: Port Sudan sits on the same Red Sea shipping lane used by a substantial share of India's trade with Europe and the Mediterranean.

The country's major geographic regions include the Nile Valley (the historic agricultural spine of the country, fed by the Blue Nile and White Nile which converge at Khartoum), the semi-arid central plains (including the Gezira Scheme, one of the largest irrigated agricultural schemes in the world), the western regions of Darfur and Kordofan (predominantly pastoral and rain fed agricultural, and the epicentre of the current conflict), and the eastern coastal belt along the Red Sea anchored by Port Sudan and Kassala.

For regional connectivity, Sudan borders seven countries and is geographically positioned to serve as a potential logistics and trade corridor between the Red Sea and landlocked or Nile Basin neighbours, including South Sudan, Chad, Central African Republic and Ethiopia a role that is presently constrained by conflict but remains structurally significant for long term planning.

Sudan's location also provides access to important regional markets through the Red Sea and its connections with the wider Horn of Africa and Middle East. Port Sudan serves as the country's principal maritime gateway and plays a critical role in the movement of imports, exports and humanitarian supplies. Its proximity to the Arabian Peninsula and established maritime routes creates potential for Sudan to function as a commercial link between African markets and Asian trading partners, including India. As regional trade networks expand, improvements in port infrastructure, road connectivity, customs systems and logistics services could further strengthen Sudan's role as a regional trade and transit hub.

## 1.2 Demographics

**Population:** approximately 48.1 million as of the 2023 baseline (World Bank); the conflict has since driven large scale internal and cross border displacement, making precise current population distribution difficult to establish with confidence.

**Displacement:** Sudan is currently the site of the world's largest internal displacement crisis, with over 10 million people displaced within the country and across borders into Chad, Egypt, South Sudan and other neighbouring states since April 2023, according to humanitarian trackers and UN agencies.

**Urbanisation and youth population:** Sudan has historically had a young, growing population with a large working age cohort; pre conflict labour force estimates stood at approximately 12.06 million.

**Employment structure:** agriculture has traditionally absorbed the largest share of the workforce (historical estimates put this as high as 80% in 1998), with industry and services accounting for smaller shares; unemployment was estimated at 25% in 2020 and is understood to have risen sharply amid the conflict driven collapse of formal economic activity, though robust recent labour force surveys are not available.

Sudan's demographic structure has important implications for its economic recovery. The country has a large young population, creating substantial long term potential for workforce development, entrepreneurship and consumer market growth. However, conflict related displacement, disruption of education and employment, and reduced access to basic services have weakened human capital development. Supporting skills development, vocational education, entrepreneurship and private sector employment will therefore be important for converting Sudan's demographic potential into productive economic capacity.

The concentration of livelihoods in agriculture also makes rural economic recovery particularly important. Restoring agricultural production, strengthening food processing and value chains, and improving access to finance, inputs, technology and markets could support both employment and food security. At the same time, rebuilding urban economic activity will require the revival of small and medium enterprises, trade, logistics and essential services.

For Indian businesses and institutions, these demographic and employment characteristics indicate potential areas for cooperation in skill development, healthcare, agriculture, vocational training, digital services and enterprise development.

Sudan's demographic profile also creates a significant need for inclusive economic opportunities for youth, women and displaced communities. Expanding access to vocational training, digital skills, entrepreneurship support and small business development can help strengthen livelihoods while reducing dependence on humanitarian assistance. Partnerships between government institutions, chambers of commerce, private companies and development organisations can play an important role in connecting these groups with emerging economic opportunities.

In the longer term, Sudan's sizeable domestic market and young consumer base could support growth in sectors such as food processing, pharmaceuticals, consumer goods, telecommunications, financial services and affordable healthcare. As stability improves, the gradual return of displaced populations and restoration of economic activity could increase demand for housing, transport, education, healthcare and other essential services.

### 1.3 Natural Resources

Sudan's resource base is broad and outside conflict affected zones remains a long term structural asset for the economy.

**Table: Sudan's Principal Natural Resources**

| Resource          | Notes                                                                                                                                                                                          | Value Addition Potential for Indian Partnership                                             |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Agricultural land | An estimated one tenth of the world's arable land is located in Sudan, per Indian government (MEA) assessments; the Gezira Scheme is among the world's largest irrigated agricultural projects | High mechanisation, seeds, agrochemicals, irrigation efficiency, agro processing            |
| Livestock         | One of Africa's largest livestock populations (cattle, sheep, goats, camels), historically a major export earner                                                                               | High veterinary services, feed, cold chain, meat/leather processing                         |
| Gold              | A leading African gold producer; artisanal and small scale mining forms a significant share of output, alongside formal mining operations                                                      | Medium responsible mining technology, processing/refining equipment, mineral value addition |

| Resource       | Notes                                                                                                                                                         | Value Addition Potential for Indian Partnership                                                                             |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Petroleum      | Historic oil producer prior to South Sudan's 2011 secession, which took the majority of proven reserves; residual downstream refining capacity exists         | Medium refining, oilfield services, historically an area of Indian investment (ONGC Videsh)                                 |
| Gum arabic     | Sudan is widely recognised as the world's leading producer and exporter of gum arabic, a key input for food, pharmaceutical and cosmetics industries globally | High India is a significant importer market for gum arabic based formulations; opportunity for direct sourcing partnerships |
| Other minerals | Chromite, mica, gypsum, and other industrial minerals present but under exploited                                                                             | Medium to long term exploration and processing partnerships                                                                 |
| Fisheries      | Red Sea and Nile fisheries, currently under developed relative to potential                                                                                   | Medium cold chain, processing, aquaculture technology                                                                       |

## 1.4 Economic Structure

On a pre conflict structural basis (2017 estimate, the most recent widely cited sectoral breakdown), services accounted for approximately 57.8% of GDP, agriculture approximately 39.6%, and industry a comparatively small 2.6% reflecting years of underinvestment in manufacturing and the loss of oil sector contribution after South Sudan's independence in 2011.

Since April 2023, the conflict has caused a severe economic contraction. Real GDP growth is estimated to have contracted by over 20% in 2023 and by a further c. 23% in 2024, according to IMF based estimates cited by independent economic data trackers, with inflation surging into triple digits during 2024 before moderating somewhat in subsequent projections. The World Bank's most recent country economic update characterises the economy as showing only tentative early signs of recovery, concentrated in areas outside active conflict zones. A very large informal economy estimated by some private research providers at around 40% of total economic activity further complicates precise measurement.

The conflict has significantly disrupted Sudan's productive capacity, trade networks and financial system. Damage to infrastructure, interruptions to transport routes, shortages of fuel and electricity, and the disruption of banking and payment systems have affected businesses across agriculture, manufacturing, trade and services. Public finances have also come under severe pressure, while businesses face difficulties in accessing working capital, importing essential inputs and maintaining normal commercial operations.

Despite these challenges, Sudan retains important foundations for long term economic recovery. Agriculture, livestock, mining, logistics and essential consumer industries can provide a base for renewed production and employment if security and infrastructure conditions improve. Reconstruction and recovery are also likely to generate demand for construction materials, machinery, transport, healthcare, pharmaceuticals, food processing and digital services.

## 1.5 Strategic Importance of Sudan

**African perspective:** Sudan is geographically the third largest country in Africa and a member of the African Union and AfCFTA, positioning it once stability returns as a potential bridge between North Africa, the Horn of Africa and Sub Saharan markets.

**Red Sea perspective:** Port Sudan sits on a Red Sea corridor that is central to global maritime trade between Asia, the Middle East and Europe, making Sudan's ports and coastal infrastructure of enduring long term logistics interest.

**Middle East perspective:** Sudan's Arab League membership and Red Sea location connect it closely to Gulf economies, several of which (UAE, Saudi Arabia) are already Sudan's largest trading and investment partners.

**India perspective:** India is among Sudan's top trading partners on both the export and import side (2023 Central Bureau of Statistics/UN Comtrade based rankings place India within the top three import sources for Sudan), with decades of cooperation in agriculture, pharmaceuticals and energy that provide an institutional foundation for CCI India engagement once conditions allow expanded activity.

**Trade perspective:** Sudan's resource base (agriculture, livestock, minerals, gum arabic) is complementary rather than competitive with India's industrial and technology exports, creating a natural basis for two way trade growth over the medium to long term.

**Resource perspective:** Substantial untapped potential in arable land, livestock, minerals and renewable energy (solar) positions Sudan as a long horizon resource and reconstruction linked opportunity for Indian industry, subject to the security and political situation stabilising.

## 2. Embassy / Diplomatic Relations with India

### 2.1 Embassy of Sudan in India

The Embassy of the Republic of the Sudan is located at Plot No. 3, Shantipath, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi – 110021 a site provided by the Government of India in 1958, reflecting the long-standing character of the bilateral relationship.

**Table: Embassy of Sudan, New Delhi Publicly Available Contact Information**

| Item                       | Detail                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Address                    | Plot No. 3, Shantipath, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi – 110021                                                                                                                                                             |
| General/Consular Telephone | +91 11 2687 3785, +91 11 2687 3739, +91 11 2687 3185                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Working Hours              | Monday–Friday, 09:00–16:00 (subject to official holidays in both countries)                                                                                                                                          |
| Functions                  | Diplomatic representation, consular services (visas, passports, attestation, civil registration for Sudanese nationals), and a commercial/economic liaison role supporting bilateral trade and business facilitation |

Given the fluid diplomatic environment resulting from the ongoing conflict, CCI India should verify current head of mission details and designated commercial contacts directly with the Embassy before formal outreach, rather than relying on any single public directory listing.

## 2.2 India–Sudan Diplomatic Relations

India–Sudan ties are among India's older diplomatic relationships in Africa, with documented linkages dating to ancient trade contact between the Indus Valley and Nubian civilisations via Mesopotamia, and formal modern diplomatic relations established in the years following India's independence. India maintained a position of neutrality during Sudan's First (1962–1972) and Second (1983–2005) Civil Wars.

India operates its resident diplomatic mission for Sudan through the Embassy of India, Khartoum; India previously ran an honorary consulate in Port Sudan, which was closed in the 1970s. India's diplomatic footprint in the region was expanded further with the opening of a Consulate General in Juba in 2007, which became India's Embassy to the Republic of South Sudan following that country's independence in 2011.

### Political and institutional engagement

**Joint Commission Meetings (JCM):** the primary institutional mechanism for bilateral economic cooperation. The first JCM was held in New Delhi in 1997, the second in Khartoum in 2000, and the third round in New Delhi on 20–21 February 2017.

**Foreign Office Consultations (FOC):** held periodically since the first round in Khartoum in September 2000; the eighth round was held in New Delhi on 3 December 2018 at the Joint Secretary (West Asia & North Africa) level. A further round has been scheduled for 3–5 May 2026 in Port Sudan.

**Bilateral agreements:** India and Sudan have concluded close to 30 bilateral agreements and MoUs spanning trade, science and technology, media, culture, diplomatic consultations, business and small industries, legal cooperation, air services and agriculture.

### Economic and development cooperation

**Oil sector investment (2003):** bilateral economic relations reached a historic high point in 2003 with an Indian decision to invest over USD 1 billion in Sudan's oil sector (through ONGC Videsh Limited's stake in upstream petroleum operations) a landmark that illustrates the scale of cooperation possible in favourable conditions, though the current operating status of legacy energy sector investments amid the conflict is not independently verified in this paper.

**Agriculture:** Sudan is estimated to hold roughly one tenth of the world's arable land; India has built a substantial agricultural trade and technology relationship, including exporting an estimated 2,500 tractors a year to Sudan (India reportedly dominates Sudan's tractor market), along with agrochemicals (UPL is cited as a dominant supplier) and hybrid seeds (Indian seed companies including JK Seeds and Nath Seeds maintain distribution networks in Sudan).

**Healthcare:** healthcare is described by the Government of India as an important area of cooperation; approximately one third of medicines approved for use in Sudan are reported to be patented by Indian pharmaceutical companies, reflecting deep pharmaceutical trade linkages.

**Humanitarian assistance (since the conflict began):** India has provided periodic humanitarian support to Sudan, including consignments of life saving medicines (approximately 25 tonnes in May 2023 and a further 2 tonnes in March 2025) and 2,000 metric tonnes of rice handed over in July 2025, described by Indian officials as reflecting South South cooperation and solidarity with the people of Sudan.

**Education and capacity building:** India has historically extended training and capacity building support to Sudanese personnel through ITEC (Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation) and similar programmes; specific current cycle allocations for Sudan were not independently verified for this paper and should be confirmed with the Ministry of External Affairs.

## 2.3 India–Sudan Institutional Engagement

The following institutions form the existing architecture that CCI India's engagement should work alongside rather than duplicate:

Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India (West Asia & North Africa / Africa desks)  
Embassy of India, Khartoum, Embassy of the Republic of the Sudan, New Delhi, Ministry of Commerce & Industry and Department of Commerce, Government of India, Sudan's Ministry of Trade and Industry, and the Union of Chambers of Commerce of Sudan (Sudan's apex chamber body).

Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO) which led a 14 member business delegation to Sudan in November 2022 for meetings with the Union of Chambers of Commerce of Sudan Invest India (national investment promotion agency).

CCI India can serve as a facilitator and industry bridge, complementing existing government, diplomatic and trade institutions. By connecting businesses, identifying opportunities and supporting follow up, CCI India can help translate institutional relationships into practical trade, investment and partnership outcomes.

## 2.4 Existing Areas of Cooperation vs. Potential Future Cooperation

**Table: Existing vs. Potential Cooperation**

| Category           | Existing / Verified Cooperation                                                   | Potential Future Cooperation                                                                         |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Agriculture        | Tractor exports, agrochemicals, hybrid seeds, farmer facing distribution networks | Agri processing, storage/cold chain, precision agriculture technology, joint demonstration farms     |
| Healthcare         | Pharmaceutical trade; humanitarian medicine consignments                          | Hospital/diagnostics investment, telemedicine, medical device manufacturing partnerships             |
| Energy             | Historical upstream oil sector investment (ONGC Videsh, 2003)                     | Solar and renewable energy partnerships, mini grid deployment, energy efficiency projects            |
| Trade facilitation | DGCIS tracked bilateral trade; periodic business delegations (e.g., FIEO, 2022)   | A structured, standing India–Sudan business platform; B2B matchmaking; sector working groups         |
| Capacity building  | ITEC linked training support (historical)                                         | Structured skill development partnerships aligned to manufacturing, agriculture and healthcare needs |

## 2.5 India–Sudan Diplomatic Timeline

**Table: India–Sudan Diplomatic Timeline (Illustrative Milestones)**

| Year                  | Milestone                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1958                  | Government of India allots a plot in Chanakyapuri, New Delhi for construction of Sudan's Embassy and residences           |
| 1962–1972 / 1983–2005 | India maintains a position of neutrality through Sudan's First and Second Civil Wars                                      |
| 1997                  | First India–Sudan Joint Commission Meeting (JCM) held in New Delhi                                                        |
| 2000                  | Second JCM held in Khartoum; first round of Foreign Office Consultations held in Khartoum (September)                     |
| 2003                  | India decides to invest over USD 1 billion in Sudan's oil sector                                                          |
| 2007                  | India opens a Consulate General in Juba                                                                                   |
| 2011                  | South Sudan's independence; Juba mission becomes India's Embassy to South Sudan                                           |
| 2017                  | Third round of the JCM held in New Delhi (20–21 February)                                                                 |
| 2018                  | 8th round of Foreign Office Consultations held in New Delhi (3 December)                                                  |
| 2022                  | 14 member FIEO business delegation visits Sudan (November) for engagement with the Union of Chambers of Commerce of Sudan |
| April 2023            | Outbreak of armed conflict between the SAF and RSF; bilateral trade and diplomatic activity disrupted                     |
| 2023–2025             | India extends periodic humanitarian assistance (medicines, rice) to Sudan amid the conflict                               |
| May 2026              | 9th round of Foreign Office Consultations scheduled in Port Sudan [Current/Scheduled]                                     |

## 3. Major Economic & Business Sectors

This section analyses nine priority sectors identified for India–Sudan business engagement. Each profile covers the sector's current standing, principal challenges, growth and trade/investment potential, relevant Indian industry capability, and a potential facilitation role for CCI India. Given the disruption caused by the conflict, current situation assessments should be read as directional rather than precise, and are dated where figures are available.

### 3.1 Agriculture & Agribusiness

Agriculture is Sudan's largest employer and, on a pre conflict basis, its single largest contributor to GDP (c. 39.6% of GDP, 2017 estimate). Sudan holds an estimated one tenth of the world's arable land, and irrigation infrastructure such as the Gezira Scheme ranks among the largest in the world.

**Current situation:** Conflict has disrupted planting and harvest cycles in several states, contributing to severe food insecurity; areas outside active conflict zones continue to farm, and India remains an active supplier of tractors, seeds and agrochemicals even through the disruption.

**Key challenges:** Conflict driven disruption to farming calendars and supply chains; input financing constraints; degraded rural infrastructure; currency volatility raising input costs; fragmented land tenure and extension services.

**Growth / trade / investment potential:** Long term potential for farm mechanisation, hybrid seed distribution, agrochemicals, irrigation efficiency technology, post-harvest storage and food processing, once security conditions in specific regions permit expanded activity.

**Indian industry capability:** India has deep, field tested capability across tractors and farm machinery, hybrid seeds, agrochemicals and agro processing equipment, evidenced by an existing, functioning Sudan distribution network (Indian tractor exports of roughly 2,500 units/year, and established seed and agrochemical suppliers).

**Potential CCI India role:** Facilitate Agri technology demonstration linkages, connect Indian equipment/input suppliers with Sudanese distributors and farmer cooperatives in stable regions, and support market intelligence on regional food security linked demand.

### 3.2 Mining & Mineral Processing

Sudan is a significant African gold producer, with both formal and extensive artisanal/small scale mining activity; other minerals including chromite, mica and gypsum are present but under exploited.

**Current situation:** Gold mining has continued in various forms throughout the conflict and is a significant informal and formal revenue source for actors across the country; formal sector investment and exploration have been constrained by insecurity and governance uncertainty.

**Key challenges:** Insecurity in mining regions; weak formal sector governance and traceability; limited processing/refining capacity within Sudan; artisanal mining safety and environmental concerns; sanctions and reputational risk considerations for foreign investors.

**Growth / trade / investment potential:** Potential for mineral processing and value addition technology, mining equipment supply, and over the longer term and subject to governance improvements responsible sourcing partnerships.

**Indian industry capability:** Indian mining equipment manufacturers, engineering firms and mineral processing technology providers have relevant capability, though entry would need to be carefully sequenced around security and due diligence considerations.

**Potential CCI India role:** Convene knowledge sharing on responsible mining practices once conditions allow; connect Indian mining equipment and processing technology firms with vetted Sudanese counterparts through a phased, risk aware approach.

### 3.3 Livestock & Animal Husbandry

Sudan holds one of the largest livestock populations in Africa (cattle, sheep, goats and camels) and livestock exports have historically been a significant, though under realised, source of foreign exchange, particularly to Gulf markets.

**Current situation:** Livestock movement and trade have been disrupted in conflict affected states, though production continues in more stable regions; live animal exports to the Gulf remain an important channel.

**Key challenges:** Animal health and veterinary service gaps; underdeveloped cold chain and processing infrastructure; disrupted transport corridors; limited value addition (most exports are live animals rather than processed products).

**Growth / trade / investment potential:** Significant potential in veterinary pharmaceuticals, animal feed, dairy and meat processing, leather value addition and cold chain logistics sectors where demand will persist and likely grow as stability returns.

**Indian industry capability:** India has a large veterinary pharmaceutical and animal health industry, leather processing expertise, and dairy/meat processing technology providers well suited to partnership and technology transfer.

**Potential CCI India role:** Facilitate veterinary pharma and animal health partnerships; support cold chain and leather processing technology linkages; enable market studies on Sudan's livestock export potential to the Gulf and India.

### 3.4 Manufacturing & Agro Processing

Sudan's formal manufacturing base is historically narrow cited main industries include cotton ginning, textiles, cement, edible oils, sugar, soap, footwear, pharmaceuticals and vehicle assembly and industry's overall GDP share is small (c. 2.6% in the 2017 baseline).

**Current situation:** Formal manufacturing has been severely affected by conflict related damage to industrial zones (including in Khartoum and Gezira states), power shortages and supply chain breaks; production has shifted where possible to less affected regions.

**Key challenges:** Physical damage to factories and industrial estates; power and input supply disruptions; access to trade finance; currency instability affecting imported input costs; skills attrition due to displacement.

**Growth / trade / investment potential:** Reconstruction linked demand for construction materials, packaging, textiles and light manufacturing; agro processing tied to Sudan's agricultural base (edible oils, sugar, food processing) represents a durable long term opportunity.

**Indian industry capability:** India's strength in MSME scale manufacturing, agro processing machinery, textile machinery and light engineering is directly relevant to Sudan's rebuilding needs.

**Potential CCI India role:** Support MSME to MSME partnerships, joint venture and contract manufacturing matchmaking, and technology transfer for agro processing once specific industrial zones stabilise.

### 3.5 Energy & Renewable Energy

Sudan's energy sector has historically centred on petroleum (with reduced reserves after South Sudan's 2011 secession) alongside hydropower; grid reliability has long been a constraint even before the conflict.

**Current situation:** The conflict has caused significant damage to power infrastructure and disrupted fuel supply chains in several regions, worsening chronic power shortages.

**Key challenges:** Damaged/degraded grid infrastructure; fuel supply disruption; limited renewable energy penetration to date; financing constraints for new generation capacity.

**Growth / trade / investment potential:** Strong potential for decentralised and off grid solar solutions, mini grids and industrial captive solar power technologies well suited to a dispersed, infrastructure constrained environment, plus longer term grid rebuilding opportunities.

**Indian industry capability:** India has a globally competitive solar equipment and EPC industry, plus mini grid and rural electrification experience directly transferable to Sudan's context.

**Potential CCI India role:** Facilitate India–Sudan dialogue on solar and mini grid solutions, connect Indian renewable energy EPC firms with Sudanese utilities/private developers, and support market assessment of off grid demand.

### 3.6 Infrastructure & Construction

Sudan's infrastructure roads, housing, industrial facilities and public buildings was already under developed relative to its size before 2023, and conflict has caused substantial additional destruction, particularly in Khartoum, Omdurman and parts of Darfur and Kordofan.

**Current situation:** Reconstruction needs are large and growing as the conflict continues; formal reconstruction planning is limited pending greater political and security clarity.

**Key challenges:** Active conflict continuing to damage infrastructure even as some areas begin rebuilding; financing constraints; unclear reconstruction governance framework; security risk for contractors and investors.

**Growth / trade / investment potential:** Substantial long term reconstruction linked opportunity in roads, housing, industrial facilities, warehousing and construction materials, expected to materialise progressively as stability returns to different regions.

**Indian industry capability:** India has deep engineering, procurement and construction (EPC) capability and construction materials manufacturing relevant to reconstruction phase demand, including experience in fragile and post conflict markets elsewhere in Africa.

**Potential CCI India role:** Build an early stage knowledge base and contractor/supplier directory so that Indian EPC and construction materials firms are positioned to engage as and when formal reconstruction programmes are established.

### 3.7 Logistics, Ports & Trade

Port Sudan is the country's principal seaport and the critical gateway for nearly all seaborne trade; since 2023 it has also taken on an elevated role as the interim centre of government and diplomatic activity.

**Current situation:** Port Sudan has continued to function as Sudan's main trade gateway through the conflict, even as overland logistics routes to and from other regions have been repeatedly disrupted.

**Key challenges:** Overland transport disruption and insecurity on key corridors; congestion and capacity constraints at Port Sudan; customs and documentation inefficiencies; elevated freight and insurance costs due to risk premiums.

**Growth / trade / investment potential:** Opportunities in warehousing, port linked logistics services, distribution and trade facilitation technology, and in supporting reliable Red Sea shipping linkages between India and Sudan.

**Indian industry capability:** Indian logistics, warehousing and freight forwarding companies, along with IT enabled trade facilitation and customs technology providers, have relevant, exportable capability.

**Potential CCI India role:** Support market intelligence on Port Sudan linked logistics capacity, and facilitate B2B links between Indian logistics/freight forwarding firms and Sudanese counterparts and clearing agents.

### 3.8 Healthcare & Pharmaceuticals

Healthcare is a long standing area of strength in the bilateral relationship: roughly one third of medicines approved for use in Sudan are reported to be patented by Indian pharmaceutical companies, reflecting a deep existing trade relationship.

**Current situation:** The conflict has severely damaged healthcare infrastructure and disrupted medical supply chains in several states; India has responded with periodic humanitarian medicine consignments.

**Key challenges:** Damaged or non-functional health facilities in conflict zones; medicine and medical supply shortages; disrupted cold chains for vaccines and biologics; shortage of trained healthcare personnel due to displacement.

**Growth / trade / investment potential:** Significant near term humanitarian linked demand for essential medicines and medical supplies, and longer term opportunity in hospital investment, diagnostics, telemedicine and local pharmaceutical/medical device manufacturing partnerships.

**Indian industry capability:** India's globally competitive generic pharmaceutical industry, medical device manufacturers, and telemedicine/digital health providers are directly relevant, building on an already substantial pharmaceutical trade relationship.

**Potential CCI India role:** Facilitate structured B2B engagement between Indian pharmaceutical/medical device exporters and Sudanese distributors and health authorities; support telemedicine and training partnerships as healthcare infrastructure stabilises.

### 3.9 Education, Skills & Employment

Sudan's education and technical training infrastructure has been significantly disrupted by the conflict, at a time when the country's large youth population will require substantial reskilling to support any post conflict recovery.

**Current situation:** Displacement has disrupted schooling and vocational training access for millions; skills gaps are widening across manufacturing, healthcare, agriculture and digital sectors.

**Key challenges:** Disrupted access to education and training; loss of skilled personnel through displacement/migration; limited vocational training infrastructure; financing constraints for skilling programmes.

**Growth / trade / investment potential:** Substantial long term opportunity for skills partnerships aligned to reconstruction era demand manufacturing, agriculture, construction, healthcare, logistics, digital skills and entrepreneurship.

**Indian industry capability:** India has a large and internationally active skill development ecosystem (ITEC linked training, vocational training providers, digital skilling platforms) well suited to structured, outcome linked partnerships.

**Potential CCI India role:** Serve as a platform connecting Indian training institutions and industry bodies with Sudanese training needs, supporting the proposed India–Sudan Skills & Industry Academy.

### 3.10 Sector Comparison Matrix

**Table: Sector Opportunity Comparison**

| Sector                          | Current Importance | Key Challenge                         | Opportunity                      | Indian Capability | CCI Role               | Priority |
|---------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------|------------------------|----------|
| Agriculture & Agribusiness      | Very High          | Conflict disruption to farming cycles | Mechanisation, seeds, processing | Very High         | Facilitator/Matchmaker | High     |
| Mining & Mineral Processing     | Medium High        | Insecurity, weak governance           | Equipment, processing tech       | Medium            | Knowledge partner      | Medium   |
| Livestock & Animal Husbandry    | High               | Animal health, cold chain gaps        | Vet pharma, processing, leather  | High              | Facilitator            | High     |
| Manufacturing & Agro Processing | Medium             | Damaged industrial zones              | MSME partnerships, JV            | High              | Matchmaker             | Medium   |
| Energy & Renewable Energy       | Medium High        | Damaged grid, fuel disruption         | Solar, mini grids                | Very High         | Enabler                | High     |

| Sector                         | Current Importance | Key Challenge                      | Opportunity                          | Indian Capability | CCI Role          | Priority |
|--------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|----------|
| Infrastructure & Construction  | High (long term)   | Ongoing conflict damage            | Reconstruction linked EPC            | High              | Knowledge partner | Medium   |
| Logistics, Ports & Trade       | High               | Corridor insecurity, congestion    | Warehousing, freight, trade tech     | Medium High       | Facilitator       | High     |
| Healthcare & Pharmaceuticals   | Very High          | Damaged facilities, supply gaps    | Pharma/medical devices, telemedicine | Very High         | Matchmaker        | High     |
| Education, Skills & Employment | High (long term)   | Disrupted access, skills attrition | Vocational/skills partnerships       | High              | Capacity builder  | High     |

## 4. Key Challenges

Sudan's challenges are deeply interconnected, with conflict related disruptions affecting economic activity, infrastructure, trade, finance, human capital and access to essential services. The prolonged instability has reduced business confidence, disrupted supply chains and constrained the ability of domestic enterprises to operate at normal capacity. These pressures have also increased the cost and complexity of conducting business, particularly for companies dependent on imported inputs, transportation networks and formal financial channels.

From a business perspective, the priority is therefore not only to identify constraints but also to understand how they can be addressed through practical, market oriented interventions. This includes supporting the continuity of legitimate trade, strengthening business to business linkages, improving access to market information, developing private sector capabilities and encouraging responsible investment when conditions permit. Such engagement should remain responsive to Sudan's evolving circumstances and avoid creating commercial exposure where security, regulatory or operational conditions remain unsuitable.

India and CCI India can potentially contribute through an industry facilitation approach focused on knowledge exchange, business networking and institutional linkages rather than political intervention.

CCI India can help connect Indian and Sudanese businesses, chambers, sector associations and relevant institutions; facilitate structured B2B interactions; share information on Indian technologies and solutions; and identify areas where Indian expertise can support Sudan's recovery needs. This role can help build commercial understanding and relationships that are ready to scale when conditions become more conducive to sustained trade and investment.

CCI India's engagement can be phased starting with low risk activities like diaspora outreach, market intelligence and virtual B2B exchanges, then expanding as conditions improve. This keeps Indian businesses informed and ready to move quickly once Sudan's environment becomes more conducive to trade and investment.

A further priority is to strengthen information and institutional connectivity between the two markets. Regular business briefings, sector specific knowledge sharing and coordinated engagement with chambers and government linked institutions can help reduce information gaps, improve preparedness and create a stronger foundation for future commercial cooperation.

## 4.1 Conflict and Political Instability

**Problem:** Since April 15, 2023, Sudan has been in active civil conflict between the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) and the Rapid Support Forces (RSF). By early 2026, over 100,000 people are estimated to have been killed, more than 10 million displaced, and repeated ceasefire attempts (Jeddah 2023, Geneva 2024, and a December 2025 proposal by the Transitional Prime Minister, have not produced a durable settlement. Reports from monitoring organisations describe continued territorial contestation, including RSF expansion into Kordofan states and the fall of El Fashir in October 2025.

**Economic impact:** Sustained loss of output (real GDP contracted an estimated 20%+ in 2023 and a further c. 23% in 2024), destruction of productive assets, and diversion of public resources to conflict.

**Business impact:** Direct physical risk to personnel and assets; near impossibility of normal commercial operations in active conflict zones; elevated insurance, security and logistics costs even in stable areas.

**Potential response:** Business engagement should be sequenced geographically (prioritising more stable regions and Port Sudan linked corridors) and structured around trade and knowledge partnerships rather than physical investment until security stabilises.

**Role of India:** India has maintained a position of principled engagement and humanitarian support without taking sides in the conflict, consistent with its historical stance of neutrality during Sudan's earlier civil wars.

**Potential CCI role:** CCI India should maintain a strictly non-political, industry facilitation posture, monitor the security situation continuously through official channels, and avoid any activity that could be construed as taking a political position.

## 4.2 Economic Contraction

**Problem:** Real GDP is estimated to have contracted sharply in 2023 and 2024, following the conflict's disruption of agriculture, trade, industry and public finances.

**Economic impact:** Falling incomes, rising poverty, reduced tax revenues, and a widening gap between formal and informal economic activity (with the informal sector estimated at around 40% of total activity by some private research providers).

**Business impact:** Shrinking domestic demand and reduced purchasing power for imported goods, constraining near term commercial opportunity outside essential/humanitarian linked categories.

**Potential response:** Focus near term commercial engagement on essential goods (pharmaceuticals, food, Agri inputs) with resilient demand; build a long term pipeline for reconstruction linked opportunities.

**Role of India:** India's continued export of essential goods (pharmaceuticals, food staples, Agri inputs) helps sustain bilateral trade even through the downturn.

**Potential CCI role:** Track World Bank/IMF economic updates and share periodic market condition briefings with Indian industry to calibrate engagement timing.

## 4.3 Inflation and Currency Instability

**Problem:** Sudan has experienced very high inflation through the conflict period estimated at over 170% in 2024 by some trackers, with projections for continued elevated (though moderating) inflation into 2026, alongside significant depreciation and volatility in the Sudanese Pound.

**Economic impact:** Erosion of purchasing power, unpredictable input costs for businesses, and complications in pricing and contract structuring for cross border trade.

**Business impact:** Difficulty for exporters and importers alike in setting stable prices; currency conversion and repatriation risk for any Indian companies with local receivables.

**Potential response:** Structure trade in hard currency where possible; use trade finance instruments that hedge currency risk; maintain conservative payment terms.

**Role of India:** N/A (macroeconomic monetary policy is a Sudanese sovereign matter).

**Potential CCI role:** Share general guidance/awareness with Indian exporters on currency and payment risk management for Sudan bound trade, sourced from Indian banks and trade finance institutions.

## 4.4 Food Security and Agricultural Disruption

**Problem:** Conflict has disrupted planting and harvest cycles, displaced farming populations, and cut off supply chains in several states, contributing to what humanitarian agencies have characterised as a severe and, in parts of the country, famine level food security crisis.

**Economic impact:** Reduced agricultural output undermines both a key GDP contributor and a major source of livelihoods and export earnings.

**Business impact:** Constrains near term agribusiness investment in affected regions, though it sustains demand for agricultural inputs, food processing and food security linked trade in stable areas.

**Potential response:** Prioritise engagement with agricultural regions outside active conflict zones; align with international food security responses (FAO, WFP) rather than duplicate them.

**Role of India:** India has extended food related humanitarian assistance (2,000 MT of rice, July 2025) and maintains active commercial Agri input trade.

**Potential CCI role:** Support market linkage facilitation for Indian Agri input suppliers in stable agricultural regions, distinct from and complementary to humanitarian food aid channels.

## 4.5 Infrastructure Gaps

**Problem:** Pre-existing infrastructure deficits in power, roads, water and industrial facilities have been substantially worsened by conflict related destruction, particularly in Khartoum, Omdurman, Gezira and Darfur/Kordofan states.

**Economic impact:** Higher costs of doing business economy wide; constrained industrial productivity; reduced attractiveness for manufacturing investment.

**Business impact:** Direct operational risk for any physical business presence; dependence on generators and alternative power/water arrangements.

**Potential response:** Position Indian infrastructure and construction materials firms for a phased, reconstruction linked entry once formal rebuilding programmes and financing frameworks are established.

**Role of India:** Indian EPC and construction firms bring relevant experience from other fragile and post conflict African markets.

**Potential CCI role:** Build an early contractor/supplier knowledge base and maintain readiness for reconstruction phase B2G and B2B engagement.

## 4.6 Logistics and Supply Chain Constraints

**Problem:** Overland transport corridors have been repeatedly disrupted by fighting, while Port Sudan now handling an outsized share of the country's trade and diplomatic activity faces congestion and capacity pressure.

**Economic impact:** Higher freight, insurance and transaction costs across the economy; slower, less predictable trade flows.

**Business impact:** Increased delivery timelines and costs for Indian exporters/importers; need for contingency logistics planning.

**Potential response:** Concentrate trade facilitation efforts on the Port Sudan corridor; build relationships with reliable freight forwarding and clearing partners.

**Role of India:** Indian shipping lines and logistics providers already operate on Red Sea routes relevant to Port Sudan.

**Potential CCI role:** Facilitate connections between Indian logistics/freight forwarding companies and established Port Sudan based clearing agents and forwarders.

## 4.7 Healthcare Challenges

**Problem:** Healthcare infrastructure has been severely damaged in conflict affected states, with disrupted supply chains for medicines, vaccines and medical equipment, and loss of trained health personnel through displacement.

**Economic impact:** Reduced healthcare sector economic activity and a public health crisis compounding the broader humanitarian emergency.

**Business impact:** Complicates commercial healthcare investment in affected areas, while sustaining strong demand for essential medicines and medical supplies nationally.

**Potential response:** Separate near term humanitarian/essential medicine trade facilitation from longer term commercial healthcare investment planning.

**Role of India:** India has provided humanitarian medicine consignments and maintains a large existing pharmaceutical trade relationship (roughly one third of medicines approved in Sudan are of Indian patented origin).

**Potential CCI role:** Facilitate B2B linkages for Indian pharmaceutical and medical device exporters with Sudanese distributors and health authorities.

## 4.8 Financing and Investment Constraints

**Problem:** Sudan's banking sector has been disrupted by the conflict, external debt remains very high (historically over 100% of GDP), and access to international financing and trade credit has narrowed considerably.

**Economic impact:** Constrained public investment capacity and elevated cost/scarcity of trade and project finance for private business.

**Business impact:** Difficulty securing financing or insurance for Sudan linked trade and investment; reliance on advance payment or third country financing structures.

**Potential response:** Engage Indian export credit institutions (ECGC, EXIM Bank) early to structure appropriate risk cover mechanisms for Sudan bound trade.

**Role of India:** India's EXIM Bank and export credit infrastructure can, in principle, support structured trade finance solutions.

**Potential CCI role:** Connect interested Indian exporters with Indian trade finance and export credit institutions for Sudan specific guidance.

## 4.9 Regulatory and Institutional Challenges

**Problem:** The transitional and conflict affected nature of Sudan's governance has created uncertainty around regulatory continuity, institutional capacity and the enforceability of commercial agreements.

**Economic impact:** Elevated regulatory and contract enforcement risk across the economy, discouraging longer horizon investment.

**Business impact:** Difficulty conducting standard due diligence and securing reliable regulatory guidance for market entry or investment.

**Potential response:** Rely on verified government to government and chamber to chamber channels for regulatory information rather than informal sources; favour trade relationships over capital intensive investment until institutional clarity improves.

**Role of India:** N/A (a matter for Sudanese institutional evolution).

**Potential CCI role:** Maintain updated regulatory and business environment briefings for Indian industry, sourced from verified official channels.

## 4.10 Business Environment Challenges

**Problem:** Compounding conflict related disruption, Sudan has long faced structural business environment constraints including bureaucratic processes, limited digital infrastructure for trade, and constrained access to reliable market information.

**Economic impact:** Higher transaction costs and reduced ease of doing business relative to peer economies.

**Business impact:** Slower market entry and higher due diligence costs for foreign companies, including Indian firms, evaluating Sudan.

**Potential response:** Provide structured market intelligence support to reduce information asymmetry for interested Indian businesses.

**Potential CCI role:** Develop and maintain a periodically updated Sudan market intelligence resource for CCI member companies.

## 4.11 Trade and Market Access Constraints

**Problem:** Bilateral trade has declined sharply since 2023 (Government of India data show a c. 34.6% year on year fall in total bilateral trade value in the most recent reporting period), reflecting both conflict disruption and broader access constraints including documentation, standards alignment and payment channel limitations.

**Economic impact:** Reduced trade volumes limit the economic benefit both economies could otherwise realise from their complementary trade profiles.

**Business impact:** Fewer viable transaction opportunities in the near term, with greater due diligence and payment risk management burden on both sides.

**Potential response:** Focus on resilient trade categories (essential goods, Agri inputs, pharmaceuticals) while building the institutional relationships needed to scale trade quickly once conditions improve.

**Role of India:** India's Department of Commerce and DGCIS trade data infrastructure provide a basis for monitoring recovery in trade flows.

**Potential CCI role:** Track bilateral trade trends on an ongoing basis and flag recovery signals to Indian exporters/importers as they emerge.

## 4.12 Challenge–Opportunity Matrix

**Table: Challenge → Opportunity Matrix**

| Challenge                      | Business Implication                    | Corresponding Opportunity                                  | CCI Facilitation Angle                                     |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Conflict & instability         | Operational and personnel risk          | Geographically sequenced, low trade capital engagement     | Non-political facilitation; continuous security monitoring |
| Economic contraction           | Weak near term domestic demand          | Essential goods trade (pharma, food, Agri inputs)          | Market condition briefings for Indian exporters            |
| Inflation/currency instability | Pricing & payment risk                  | Hard currency, trade finance backed transactions           | Awareness support on payment risk management               |
| Food security crisis           | Disrupted Agri output in conflict zones | Agri input demand in stable regions                        | Facilitate Agri input market linkages                      |
| Infrastructure gaps            | High cost of physical operations        | Reconstruction linked EPC & materials demand (medium term) | Build contractor/supplier readiness pipeline               |
| Logistics constraints          | Higher freight/insurance costs          | Port Sudan corridor logistics partnerships                 | Connect Indian logistics firms with local forwarders       |
| Healthcare system strain       | Damaged facilities, supply gaps         | Pharma & medical device trade; telemedicine                | B2B matchmaking for pharma/MedTech exporters               |
| Education & skills gaps        | Shrinking skilled labour pool           | Structured skilling partnerships                           | Anchor Skills & Industry Academy concept                   |
| Financing constraints          | Scarce trade/project finance            | Export credit backed trade structures                      | Connect exporters with EXIM Bank/ECGC                      |
| Regulatory uncertainty         | High due diligence burden               | Verified channel regulatory guidance                       | Maintain business environment briefings                    |
| Weak business environment      | Information asymmetry                   | Structured market intelligence                             | Sudan market resource for members                          |

## 5. India–Sudan Trade & Economic Relations

### 5.1 Bilateral Trade

India is among Sudan's most significant trading partners on both the export and import side. Government of India data (DGCIS) show total bilateral trade of approximately USD 876.01 million in the most recent full reporting year, comprising India's exports of USD 337.57 million.

India's imports of USD 538.44 million a year on year decline of approximately 34.6% in total trade value, which the Government of India directly attributes to the disruption caused by the armed conflict that broke out on 15 April 2023.

UN Comtrade based mirror statistics (accessed via Trading Economics) show a broadly similar but not identical picture for calendar year 2024: India's exports to Sudan of USD 544.77 million and India's imports from Sudan of USD 419.3 million.

### 5.2 India's Major Exports to Sudan

Per UN Comtrade data for 2024 (via Trading Economics), India's exports to Sudan were led by sugar and sugar confectionery, followed by pharmaceutical products and cereals reflecting both India's competitive strength in these categories and Sudan's essential goods import needs during the conflict period. These trade patterns also highlight clear opportunities for further diversification and expansion of India Sudan commercial ties.

**Table: India's Major Exports to Sudan, 2024 (USD Million)**

| Product Category                     | Value (USD Mn, 2024) | Trade Relevance / Future Potential                                                                                |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sugars & sugar confectionery         | 286.15               | Largest single export category; reflects Sudan's food import dependence; likely to remain a resilient category    |
| Pharmaceutical products              | 79.75                | Reflects deep existing pharma trade relationship; strong potential for further growth as healthcare needs persist |
| Cereals                              | 38.78                | Food security linked category with resilient demand                                                               |
| Machinery, nuclear reactors, boilers | 14.03                | Relevant to agriculture mechanisation and industrial equipment demand                                             |
| Miscellaneous chemical products      | 13.10                | Includes agrochemical linked categories                                                                           |

| Product Category                                 | Value (USD Mn, 2024) | Trade Relevance / Future Potential                              |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Plastics                                         | 10.19                | Packaging and industrial input demand                           |
| Rubber                                           | 8.48                 | Industrial and automotive linked demand                         |
| Textile inputs (wadding, felt, nonwovens, yarns) | 7.89                 | Textile sector linkage                                          |
| Electrical/electronic equipment                  | 7.50                 | Potential growth category linked to infrastructure/energy needs |
| Optical, photo, technical & medical apparatus    | 7.34                 | Healthcare linked category with growth potential                |
| Vehicles (non rail/tram)                         | 7.04                 | Transport and logistics linked demand                           |

Beyond the Comtrade product breakdown, the Government of India's own bilateral brief characterises India's exports more broadly as spanning foodstuffs, petroleum products, manufactured goods, machinery and equipment, chemicals (including pharmaceuticals) and textiles.

### 5.3 Sudan's Major Exports to India

Sudan's exports to India are concentrated in agricultural and natural resource commodities. Per the Government of India's bilateral brief, Sudan mainly exports sesame seed, gum arabic, cotton, watermelon seeds, hides and skins, and groundnuts to India.

**Sesame seed:** a longstanding major Sudanese export to India, used in food processing and oil extraction; India is among the world's largest sesame importers.

**Gum arabic:** Sudan is widely regarded as the world's leading producer and exporter of gum arabic, used in food, pharmaceutical and cosmetic applications; a natural anchor commodity for structured India–Sudan sourcing partnerships.

**Cotton:** relevant to India's large textile manufacturing base.

**Hides and skins:** an input for India's leather processing industry, complementary to potential livestock sector partnerships.

**Groundnuts and watermelon seeds:** established Agri commodity export categories.

## 5.4 Trade Trends

The overarching trend since April 2023 is a sharp decline in bilateral trade value, consistent with the broader contraction of Sudan's formal economy. Government of India data show a 34.6% year on year decline in the most recent reporting period, a pattern likely to persist until security and logistics conditions stabilise. Historically, the relationship had been on what Indian officials describe as "a steep rise" prior to the conflict.

## 5.5 Existing Indian Business Presence

Verified information on current, active Indian companies operating inside Sudan is limited in open sources, particularly given the conflict's disruption to normal business reporting. What can be confirmed from official and industry sources:

**Agriculture input suppliers:** Indian hybrid seed companies including JK Seeds and Nath Seeds are cited by the Government of India as maintaining distribution networks in Sudan; UPL is cited as a dominant player in Sudan's agrochemical sector.

**Pharmaceutical sector:** Indian pharmaceutical companies collectively hold patents on an estimated one third of medicines approved for use in Sudan, indicating substantial (though not individually named) Indian pharma commercial presence via exports/distribution.

**Historical energy sector investment:** ONGC Videsh Limited's 2003 investment in Sudan's upstream oil sector is a matter of public record; the current operating status of this and related legacy investments amid the conflict was not independently verified for this paper.

**Trade delegations:** a 14 member Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO) delegation visited Sudan in November 2022 to engage with the Union of Chambers of Commerce of Sudan.

## 5.6 Trade Barriers

**Logistics:** disrupted overland corridors and congestion pressure on Port Sudan, now handling an outsized share of national trade.

**Customs and documentation:** institutional disruption has affected the consistency and predictability of customs processing.

**Payments and currency:** high inflation, Sudanese Pound volatility, and constrained banking sector functionality complicate cross border payment settlement.

**Regulations and standards:** regulatory continuity and standards alignment information can be difficult to verify amid institutional disruption.

**Market information:** limited availability of timely, reliable market data increases due diligence costs for prospective exporters/importers.

**Security:** physical security risk affects logistics routing, insurance costs and the feasibility of in country business travel.

**Supply chains:** conflict related disruption to both Sudanese domestic supply chains and cross border logistics chains.

## 6. Trade & Investment Opportunities

### 6.1 Indian Export Opportunities

Building on the existing trade base, the most realistic near term opportunities for Indian exporters lie in categories with resilient demand even under conflict conditions, alongside a longer term pipeline tied to reconstruction:

- Essential foodstuffs sugar, cereals, edible oils (an established, large existing category)
- Pharmaceuticals and medical supplies (building on India's existing c. one third share of medicines approved in Sudan)
- Agricultural machinery, tractors and farm equipment (India already supplies an estimated 2,500 tractors/year)
- Agrochemicals and hybrid seeds (established distribution networks already exist)
- Textile inputs, plastics, chemicals and light manufactured goods (existing, smaller trade categories with room for growth)
- Renewable energy equipment solar panels, inverters, mini grid components (nascent but structurally promising given grid disruption)
- Construction materials and engineering goods (medium term, reconstruction linked)
- Digital and trade facilitation solutions (logistics software, telemedicine platforms early stage opportunity)

### 6.2 Sudanese Export Opportunities to India

Only product categories supported by trade data or credible government sourcing are identified here:

**Sesame seed:** an established, significant Sudan to India export category.

**Gum arabic:** Sudan's flagship global export commodity; potential for deeper direct sourcing partnerships with Indian food, pharmaceutical and cosmetics manufacturers.

**Cotton:** relevant as an input to India's textile industry.

**Hides and skins:** input for India's leather processing sector, with potential to develop into more value-added leather goods partnerships.

**Groundnuts and watermelon seeds:** established Agri commodity categories.

## 6.3 Investment Opportunities

Given the security and financing environment, near term investment opportunities are best framed as light asset, partnership based models rather than large capital commitments. The following categories represent potential (not committed) areas for Indian investment interest:

**Joint ventures:** in agro processing, animal health/veterinary pharma distribution, and light manufacturing, structured with Sudanese partners who can manage on ground operational risk.

**Technology transfer / licensing:** Agri technology, food processing and pharmaceutical formulation technology, which can be transferred with lower physical asset exposure than direct investment.

**Infrastructure and energy (longer horizon):** solar/mini grid deployment and, over the longer term as reconstruction financing frameworks emerge, broader infrastructure investment.

**Healthcare:** potential for diagnostics and telemedicine partnerships that do not require large fixed asset exposure, ahead of any direct hospital investment.

**Logistics:** potential for asset light logistics and freight forwarding partnerships anchored around the Port Sudan corridor.

## 6.4 Partnership Models

**Table: Partnership Models Relevant to the Current Sudan Operating Environment**

| Model                                     | Suitability in Current Environment                                                                      | Illustrative Sector Fit                     |
|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| B2B trade (export/import)                 | High lowest risk, already the dominant existing model                                                   | Pharma, food, Agri inputs                   |
| B2G engagement (policy/industry dialogue) | Medium useful for positioning ahead of future opportunity, subject to verified counterpart institutions | Reconstruction planning, standards dialogue |
| Joint venture with local partner          | Medium depends on partner selection and region                                                          | Agro processing, veterinary pharma          |

| Model                                        | Suitability in Current Environment                              | Illustrative Sector Fit               |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Technology transfer / licensing              | High limits physical asset exposure                             | Agri tech, pharma formulation         |
| Distribution / agency agreements             | High builds on existing successful model (seeds, agrochemicals) | Agri inputs, consumer goods           |
| Contract manufacturing                       | Low Medium depends on industrial zone stability                 | Textiles, light manufacturing         |
| EPC (engineering, procurement, construction) | Low near term; Medium High longer term                          | Infrastructure, energy                |
| Public Private Partnership (PPP)             | Low near term requires institutional clarity                    | Infrastructure, utilities (long term) |
| Training / capacity building partnerships    | High deliverable even amid conflict in stable regions           | Skills, healthcare, agriculture       |

## 5. Investment Opportunity Matrix

**Table: Sector wise Investment Opportunity Matrix**

| Sector      | Sudan Need                     | Indian Capability              | Opportunity                                          | Partnership Model        | Priority |
|-------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------|
| Agriculture | Mechanisation, inputs, storage | Tractors, seeds, agrochemicals | Expand existing distribution; add storage/processing | Distribution + JV        | High     |
| Livestock   | Animal health, processing      | Veterinary pharma, cold chain  | New vet pharma partnerships                          | Distribution + Licensing | High     |

| Sector             | Sudan Need                       | Indian Capability                       | Opportunity                             | Partnership Model         | Priority                  |
|--------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|
| Healthcare         | Medicines, devices, facilities   | Generics, medical devices, telemedicine | Expand pharma trade; pilot telemedicine | B2B trade + Training      | High                      |
| Energy             | Reliable, decentralised power    | Solar EPC, mini grids                   | Off grid/mini grid pilots               | EPC + Technology transfer | High                      |
| Logistics          | Port Sudan linked capacity       | Freight forwarding, warehousing         | Corridor logistics partnerships         | B2B agency agreements     | Medium High               |
| Manufacturing      | MSME rebuilding, agro processing | MSME machinery, processing tech         | Phased JV/contract manufacturing        | JV / Technology transfer  | Medium                    |
| Mining             | Equipment, processing technology | Mining/processing equipment             | Equipment supply partnerships           | B2B trade                 | Medium                    |
| Infrastructure     | Reconstruction (medium term)     | EPC, construction materials             | Reconstruction linked contracts         | EPC / PPP (future)        | Medium (rising over time) |
| Education & Skills | Vocational/technical training    | Skilling institutions, ITEC model       | Structured skills academy               | Training partnership      | High                      |

## 7. How CCI India Can Collaborate

### 7.1 India–Sudan Business Platform

A standing, chamber led platform convening Indian and Sudanese businesses on a recurring basis, potentially structured as periodic virtual roundtables while in person travel remains constrained, moving to in person forums as conditions allow. The platform can serve as a central mechanism for sharing business priorities, identifying opportunities and maintaining continuity of commercial engagement.

## 7.2 India–Sudan Business Facilitation Desk

A dedicated point of contact within CCI India for Sudan related queries, trade documentation guidance, partner identification support, and routing of enquiries between Indian and Sudanese businesses. The desk can also maintain a database of sector specific enquiries and help businesses navigate available institutional and market resources.

## 7.3 B2B Matchmaking

Structured matchmaking between Indian exporters/investors and vetted Sudanese counterparts, initially concentrated in resilient sectors such as agriculture, pharmaceuticals and essential goods. Matchmaking can be based on clearly defined product requirements, business profiles and commercial interests to improve the quality of partnerships. Priority can be given to Sudanese counterparts with verifiable business credentials and demonstrated operational continuity. Initial matchmaking can be conducted virtually through structured business profiles, progressing to in person engagement as conditions allow. CCI India can also maintain an updated roster of vetted Sudanese businesses across priority sectors for ready reference.

## 7.4 B2G Engagement

Facilitated dialogue between Indian industry and relevant Sudanese ministries/institutions on industry relevant policy matters, framed strictly as industry facilitation, not political engagement. The objective would be to communicate practical business concerns and identify measures that can make legitimate trade and investment easier.

## 7.5 Business Delegations

Support for periodic business delegations, building on precedents such as the FIEO delegation of November 2022, sequenced around security conditions and coordinated with the Embassy of India, Khartoum and the Embassy of Sudan in New Delhi. Where physical travel is not feasible, virtual business missions can provide an interim mechanism for maintaining engagement and developing commercial leads.

## 7.6 Investment Opportunity Catalogue

A living, periodically updated catalogue of credible, verified investment and trade opportunities across the nine priority sectors, distinguishing near term trade from longer term investment and reconstruction opportunities. Each opportunity can include basic information on sector, market need, potential partners, regulatory considerations and stage of readiness. Entries would be validated through engagement with government and industry partners, and reviewed regularly to stay current with evolving market conditions.

## 7.7 Market Intelligence

Regular market condition briefings for CCI member companies, drawing on World Bank, IMF, UN Comtrade, DGCIS and other verified sources, updated as the security and economic situation evolves. These briefings can help businesses make informed decisions regarding market entry, sourcing, demand conditions and risk exposure.

## 7.8 MSME Partnerships

Facilitation support specifically tailored to Indian MSMEs, which form the backbone of India's agri input, light manufacturing and agro processing export capability relevant to Sudan. CCI India can help identify suitable MSMEs, aggregate business enquiries and connect them with Sudanese distributors, importers and commercial partners.

## 7.9 Technology Transfer

Structured facilitation of technology transfer and licensing arrangements in agri technology, food processing and pharmaceutical formulation, using lower risk entry models suited to the current environment. Such partnerships can combine Indian technical expertise with Sudanese market knowledge and local operational capabilities. Suitable models can include technology licensing, franchise style partnerships and joint training programmes, allowing Indian companies to share expertise with limited upfront capital or physical presence. Priority areas could include drought resistant seed technology, small scale food processing and generic pharmaceutical formulation, given their relevance to Sudan's food security and recovery needs. As conditions stabilise, these arrangements can serve as a foundation for deeper collaboration, including local manufacturing partnerships.

## 7.10 Skill Development

Support for the proposed India–Sudan Skills & Industry Academy concept, connecting Indian training institutions with Sudanese skilling needs. The initiative could focus on practical, employment oriented skills linked to sectors such as agriculture, healthcare, manufacturing, logistics and digital services.

## 7.11 Industry Roundtables

Sector specific roundtables, such as agriculture, healthcare and energy, bringing together Indian and Sudanese industry participants and relevant experts. These discussions can identify specific commercial bottlenecks, partnership opportunities and areas where Indian industry can provide practical solutions. Outcomes from these roundtables could feed directly into the broader investment catalogue and inform follow-on business delegations or pilot projects.

## 7.12 Sector Working Groups

Smaller, ongoing working groups for priority sectors such as agriculture, healthcare, energy and logistics to track opportunities and coordinate facilitation activity between CCI India and industry members. Working groups can provide continuity beyond individual events and translate discussions into specific business leads, projects and follow up actions.

## 7.13 Policy & Industry Dialogue

A structured channel for sharing industry perspectives with relevant Indian and Sudanese authorities on matters affecting trade and investment facilitation, including customs, standards and logistics, strictly industry focused and not political. The dialogue can help identify procedural barriers and encourage practical improvements that support legitimate commercial activity.

## 7.14 Pilot Project Facilitation

Support for small, well defined pilot projects, such as a solar mini grid demonstration or farmer training pilot, that can generate proof points for larger partnerships once conditions stabilise. Pilots can provide businesses with an opportunity to test solutions, understand local requirements and demonstrate measurable value before committing to larger investments.

## 7.15 Trade & Export Readiness Support

Support Indian and Sudanese businesses in understanding export procedures, product standards, documentation, customs requirements and market entry considerations, helping reduce practical barriers to bilateral trade. CCI India can provide guidance resources, connect businesses with relevant experts and help improve the preparedness of first time exporters entering the India–Sudan market.

**Table: CCI India Role Framework**

| Stage          | Description                                                                                                                         |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Sudan Needs | Identified through ongoing consultations and engagement with Sudanese chambers, ministries, and the Embassy of Sudan in New Delhi.  |
| 2. CCI India   | Acts as connector, knowledge partner and facilitator aggregating needs, curating verified opportunities, and convening stakeholders |

| Stage              | Description                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3. Indian Industry | CCI member companies and the wider Indian business ecosystem (MSMEs, exporters, technology providers) evaluate and respond to curated opportunities                                 |
| 4. Partnership     | B2B, B2G, joint venture, licensing or training partnerships are structured between Indian and Sudanese counterparts                                                                 |
| 5. Implementation  | Partnerships are implemented, sequenced by security/market conditions, with CCI India continuing a facilitation (not execution) role                                                |
| 6. Impact          | Trade growth, technology transfer, capacity building and over the long term contribution to Sudan's economic recovery and an established India–Sudan industry partnership ecosystem |

## 8. Sector wise CCI India Initiatives

### 8.1 Agriculture: India–Sudan Agri Transformation Initiative

**Objective:** Strengthen Sudan's agricultural productivity and value chains through Indian Agri technology, mechanisation and training.

**Problem addressed:** Conflict disrupted farming cycles, limited mechanisation, and weak post-harvest infrastructure constrain agricultural output and farmer incomes.

**Proposed intervention:** Curated Agri technology demonstrations, farm mechanisation and food processing/packaging/storage partnerships, plus farmer and enterprise training and market linkage support, starting in stable agricultural regions.

**CCI role:** Convene Indian Agri equipment, seed and agrochemical companies with Sudanese agricultural stakeholders; curate a market intelligence resource on regional demand.

**Indian industry role:** Equipment, seed and agrochemical suppliers (building on existing distribution networks) contribute technology and training capacity.

**Sudanese stakeholder role:** Sudanese farmer cooperatives, agricultural ministries/departments and Union of Chambers of Commerce of Sudan identify priority regions and partners.

**Potential partners:** Union of Chambers of Commerce of Sudan, Sudanese Ministry of Agriculture, Indian Agri equipment/seed/agrochemical companies.

**Implementation model:** Phased demonstration projects in stable regions, scaling through distribution partnerships.

**Expected outcome:** Improved agricultural productivity and stronger India–Sudan Agri trade linkages.

**Risks:** Security access constraints in some regions; currency/financing risk; input cost volatility.

**Scalability:** High agriculture is Sudan's largest sector and the existing trade base provides a strong foundation.

## 8.2 Mining: Responsible Mining & Mineral Value Addition Programme

**Objective:** Support knowledge exchange on responsible mining practices and connect Indian mining technology and processing capability with Sudanese counterparts.

**Problem addressed:** Sudan's mining sector, particularly gold, combines significant potential with governance, safety and traceability challenges.

**Proposed intervention:** Knowledge sharing sessions on responsible/formal sector mining practices; curated introductions between Indian mining equipment/processing technology firms and vetted Sudanese counterparts.

**CCI role:** Convene knowledge sharing sessions; support due diligence informed introductions.

**Indian industry role:** Mining equipment manufacturers and mineral processing technology providers share expertise and evaluate partnership opportunities.

**Sudanese stakeholder role:** Sudanese mining authorities and formal sector mining companies engage on responsible mining knowledge exchange.

**Potential partners:** Sudanese mining ministry/authority, Indian mining equipment and engineering firms.

**Implementation model:** Knowledge exchange first, followed by carefully sequenced commercial engagement.

**Expected outcome:** Improved formal sector mining practices and potential equipment/technology trade.

**Risks:** Security risk in mining regions; governance/traceability and reputational considerations.

**Scalability:** Medium contingent on governance conditions improving.

### 8.3 Livestock: Sudan Livestock Value Chain Development Programme

**Objective:** Develop India–Sudan partnerships across animal health, processing and value addition in Sudan's livestock sector.

**Problem addressed:** Weak veterinary services, cold chain and processing infrastructure limit the value Sudan captures from a large livestock base.

**Proposed intervention:** Facilitate veterinary pharma and animal health partnerships, dairy/meat processing and leather value addition linkages, feed sector partnerships, cold chain technology introductions, and export development support.

**CCI role:** Convene Indian veterinary pharma, dairy/meat processing and leather companies with Sudanese livestock sector stakeholders.

**Indian industry role:** Veterinary pharmaceutical, feed, cold chain and leather processing companies bring technology and distribution capability.

**Sudanese stakeholder role:** Sudanese livestock ministries/departments and livestock trader associations identify priority partnership areas.

**Potential partners:** Sudanese Ministry of Animal Resources (or equivalent), Indian veterinary pharma and leather processing companies.

**Implementation model:** Distribution partnerships and technology transfer/licensing arrangements.

**Expected outcome:** Improved animal health outcomes, expanded value added livestock exports.

**Risks:** Transport/corridor disruption; animal health infrastructure gaps.

**Scalability:** High builds on one of Sudan's largest natural resource endowments.

## 8.4 Manufacturing: Sudan Industrial & Processing Partnership Programme

**Objective:** Support the phased rebuilding of Sudan's manufacturing and agro processing base through Indian MSME and technology partnerships.

**Problem addressed:** Conflict damage to industrial zones and constrained financing have set back Sudan's already narrow manufacturing base.

**Proposed intervention:** Facilitate MSME to MSME partnerships, joint ventures and contract manufacturing arrangements in agro processing, textiles, leather, pharmaceuticals and construction materials, sequenced around stable industrial locations.

**CCI role:** Curate MSME partnership opportunities; support market entry knowledge sharing.  
**Indian industry role:** Indian MSME manufacturers and agro processing equipment suppliers evaluate joint venture and technology transfer opportunities.

**Sudanese stakeholder role:** Sudanese manufacturers and industrial zone authorities identify viable partnership sites and counterparts.

**Potential partners:** Sudanese Ministry of Industry, Sudanese manufacturers' associations, Indian MSME industry bodies.

**Implementation model:** Joint ventures and contract manufacturing, phased by industrial zone stability.

**Expected outcome:** Rebuilt processing capacity and stronger India–Sudan manufacturing linkages.

**Risks:** Physical infrastructure damage; power supply constraints; financing access.

**Scalability:** Medium dependent on the pace of industrial zone stabilisation.

## 8.5 Energy: India–Sudan Clean Energy Partnership

**Objective:** Connect Indian renewable energy capability with Sudan's decentralised and grid linked power needs.

**Problem addressed:** Damaged grid infrastructure and chronic power shortages constrain both households and industry.

**Proposed intervention:** Facilitate introductions between Indian solar EPC/mini grid companies and Sudanese utilities/private developers; support pilot off grid/mini grid demonstration projects; explore industrial captive solar and energy efficiency opportunities.

**CCI role:** Convene Indian renewable energy companies with Sudanese counterparts; support pilot project facilitation.

**Indian industry role:** Indian solar EPC, mini grid and energy storage companies bring globally competitive technology and delivery experience.

**Sudanese stakeholder role:** Sudanese utilities, private power developers and industrial users identify priority sites and demand.

**Potential partners:** Sudanese electricity authority/utilities, Indian renewable energy EPC companies, Invest India.

**Implementation model:** Pilot mini grid/off grid projects, scaling to larger EPC engagements

**Expected outcome:** Improved decentralised power access and a foundation for larger energy partnerships.

**Risks:** Financing constraints; security access for project sites; grid integration uncertainty.

**Scalability:** High off grid solar is well suited to a dispersed, infrastructure constrained environment.

## 8.6 Infrastructure: India–Sudan Rebuild & Build Partnership

**Objective:** Position Indian EPC and construction materials capability for Sudan's eventual reconstruction phase.

**Problem addressed:** Conflict related destruction has created substantial infrastructure needs, but formal reconstruction financing and governance frameworks are not yet established.

**Proposed intervention:** Build an early stage knowledge base and contractor/supplier directory; engage in preparatory dialogue with relevant authorities and development institutions on reconstruction planning, ready to activate as programmes are established.

**CCI role:** Maintain contractor/supplier readiness resource; support B2G dialogue on reconstruction planning as institutional frameworks develop.

**Indian industry role:** Indian EPC firms and construction materials manufacturers build readiness and relevant regional experience.

**Sudanese stakeholder role:** Sudanese infrastructure/housing ministries and reconstruction coordination bodies (once established) identify priority projects.

**Potential partners:** Sudanese infrastructure ministries, African Development Bank, World Bank, Indian EPC and construction materials companies.

**Implementation model:** Preparatory/readiness phase now; EPC and PPP engagement once reconstruction financing frameworks exist.

**Expected outcome:** Indian industry positioned to participate credibly once formal reconstruction begins.

**Risks:** High uncertainty on reconstruction timeline and financing; security risk in target regions.

**Scalability:** High (long term) reconstruction needs are substantial once conditions allow.

## 8.7 Logistics & Trade: India–Sudan Trade & Logistics Facilitation Initiative

**Objective:** Strengthen trade facilitation and logistics linkages anchored around the Port Sudan corridor.

**Problem addressed:** Overland corridor disruption and port congestion raise costs and reduce trade predictability.

**Proposed intervention:** Facilitate connections between Indian logistics/freight forwarding companies and established Port Sudan based clearing agents; support market intelligence on port capacity and shipping line options; explore warehousing and distribution partnerships.

**CCI role:** Curate logistics partner introductions; maintain corridor condition market intelligence.

**Indian industry role:** Indian logistics, freight forwarding and warehousing companies evaluate partnership and market entry options.

**Sudanese stakeholder role:** Port Sudan authorities and Sudanese clearing/forwarding agents provide on ground logistics expertise.

**Potential partners:** Port Sudan Sea Ports Corporation (or equivalent authority), Indian shipping lines and logistics companies, FIEO.

**Implementation model:** B2B agency and distribution partnerships.

**Expected outcome:** More reliable, cost effective India–Sudan trade logistics.

**Risks:** Corridor security risk; port congestion; documentation/customs uncertainty.

**Scalability:** Medium High Port Sudan's centrality to national trade makes this a durable focus area.

## 8.8 Healthcare: India–Sudan Healthcare Partnership

**Objective:** Expand India's already substantial pharmaceutical and healthcare trade relationship with Sudan into deeper partnership models.

**Problem addressed:** Damaged healthcare infrastructure, medicine and medical supply shortages, and disrupted health workforce availability.

**Proposed intervention:** Facilitate structured B2B engagement between Indian pharmaceutical/medical device exporters and Sudanese distributors and health authorities; support telemedicine and healthcare training partnerships as infrastructure stabilises.

**CCI role:** Convene healthcare sector roundtables; support B2B matchmaking for pharma/MedTech exporters.

**Indian industry role:** Indian pharmaceutical, medical device and telemedicine companies build on an existing strong trade base.

**Sudanese stakeholder role:** Sudanese Ministry of Health and healthcare distributors identify priority needs and partnership structures.

**Potential partners:** Sudanese Ministry of Health, Indian pharmaceutical/medical device industry bodies.

**Implementation model:** B2B trade expansion, with training/telemedicine pilots.

**Expected outcome:** Sustained essential medicine supply and stronger long term healthcare sector partnership.

**Risks:** Supply chain disruption; facility damage in conflict zones; payment/financing risk.

**Scalability:** High builds on one of the strongest existing pillars of the bilateral relationship.

## 8.9 Education & Skills: India–Sudan Skills & Industry Academy

**Objective:** Build a structured, outcome linked skilling pathway connecting Indian training capability to Sudan's reconstruction era workforce needs.

**Problem addressed:** Displacement and infrastructure damage have disrupted education and vocational training, widening skills gaps precisely when a young population will be central to Sudan's recovery.

**Proposed intervention:** Curate connections between Indian vocational training institutions/industry bodies and Sudanese training needs, focused on manufacturing, agriculture, construction, healthcare, logistics, digital skills and entrepreneurship, following a Learn → Train → Work → Earn → Grow pathway.

**CCI role:** Convene Indian training institutions and industry bodies; support curriculum and partnership design input.

**Indian industry role:** Indian vocational training providers and industry bodies (building on ITEC style experience) contribute training capacity.

**Sudanese stakeholder role:** Sudanese training institutions, industry associations and relevant ministries identify priority skill needs and cohorts.

**Potential partners:** Ministry of External Affairs (ITEC), Sudanese training institutions, Indian industry/skilling bodies.

**Implementation model:** Structured training partnerships, potentially blended (online/in person) given access constraints.

**Expected outcome:** A pipeline of skilled workers aligned to reconstruction era sector needs.

**Risks:** Access and connectivity constraints; funding for sustained programme delivery.

**Scalability:** High skills development is deliverable even amid ongoing conflict in accessible regions.

## 9. Potential B2B / B2G Partnerships

### 9.1 B2G Opportunities

The following are potential areas for engagement with Sudanese public institutions. These are identified as areas for engagement, not confirmed projects, procurement or approvals:

**Ministry of Agriculture:** potential area for engagement on Agri mechanisation and food security linked programming.

**Ministry of Health:** potential area for engagement on essential medicine supply chains and healthcare training partnerships.

**Ministry of Energy / electricity authorities:** potential area for engagement on decentralised/renewable power planning.

**Port Sudan Sea Ports Corporation (or equivalent authority):** potential area for engagement on logistics and trade facilitation improvements.

**Union of Chambers of Commerce of Sudan:** a natural chamber to chamber counterpart for CCI India, building on the precedent of the 2022 FIEO delegation.

**Regional/state authorities in stable regions:** potential area for engagement on region specific agriculture or energy pilots.

**Development institutions (African Development Bank, World Bank, UNDP):** potential area for engagement on aligning Indian industry capability with internationally financed development programming, once such programming is defined.

## 9.2 Illustrative Partnership Concepts

The following concepts are labelled "Illustrative Opportunity Subject to Stakeholder Validation" and are intended to prompt discussion, not represent confirmed initiatives.

### **Agri Mechanisation Demonstration Hub [Illustrative Opportunity – Subject to Stakeholder Validation]**

**Sector:** Agriculture

**Opportunity:** A demonstration site showcasing Indian tractors, implements and irrigation efficiency technology to Sudanese farmer cooperatives in a stable agricultural region.

**Indian capability:** Indian tractor/implement manufacturers, Agri technology providers.

**Sudanese requirement:** Farmer training and mechanisation access.

**Partnership model:** Equipment supply + training partnership.

**Expected outcome:** Wider mechanisation adoption and stronger distributor networks.

**CCI role:** Convene, curate and facilitate introductions; not an executing or financing party.

### **Veterinary Health & Cold Chain Pilot [Illustrative Opportunity – Subject to Stakeholder Validation]**

**Sector:** Livestock

**Opportunity:** A pilot combining veterinary pharma supply with basic cold chain infrastructure in a livestock producing region.

**Indian capability:** Indian veterinary pharma and cold chain equipment companies.

**Sudanese requirement:** Improved animal health and reduced post-harvest loss.

**Partnership model:** Distribution + equipment supply.

**Expected outcome:** Proof of concept for scaled livestock value chain investment.

**CCI role:** Convene, curate and facilitate introductions; not an executing or financing party.

**Essential Medicines Supply Partnership [Illustrative Opportunity Subject to Stakeholder Validation]**

**Sector:** Healthcare

Given Sudan's fragile health infrastructure, essential medicines remain a priority need across the country.

**Opportunity:** A structured, multi-year supply partnership between Indian generic pharma manufacturers and Sudanese distributors/health authorities for essential medicines. Could be piloted with a limited basket of high-priority essential drugs before scaling.

**Indian capability:** Indian generic pharmaceutical manufacturers. India is among the world's largest suppliers of affordable, quality-assured generic medicines.

**Sudanese requirement:** Reliable essential medicine availability. Consistent supply chains are needed to address shortages in both public and private health systems.

**Partnership model:** Long term supply agreement. Could be structured with phased volume commitments and local currency payment mechanisms.

**Expected outcome:** Strengthened health system resilience and deepened trade relationship. May also open pathways for future technology transfer or local manufacturing collaboration.

**CCI role:** Convene, curate and facilitate introductions; not an executing or financing party. Due diligence and commercial terms remain the responsibility of the participating entities.

## CONCLUSION

Sudan presents a complex but strategically important market for India. While conflict, economic disruption, displacement and infrastructure constraints continue to shape the near term business environment, the country retains significant long term potential through its agricultural resources, livestock, minerals, gum arabic, strategic Red Sea access and substantial reconstruction needs. These structural strengths, combined with the existing India–Sudan trade relationship, provide a foundation for deeper economic cooperation as conditions gradually stabilise.

For CCI India, the opportunity lies in creating the institutional and commercial foundations required for sustained engagement. This includes strengthening market intelligence, developing chamber to chamber relationships, establishing sector focused working groups, identifying credible business counterparts and facilitating structured dialogue between Indian and Sudanese enterprises. Such efforts can help reduce information gaps, improve business confidence and create a more organised pathway for Indian companies seeking to understand and eventually enter the Sudanese market.

The engagement should follow a phased and responsible approach, beginning with information sharing, institutional connectivity and resilient sectors, and gradually progressing towards trade facilitation, business delegations, investment partnerships, technology transfer and joint ventures as the operating environment improves. Priority areas such as agriculture, healthcare and pharmaceuticals, essential goods, mining related services, logistics, renewable energy and selected manufacturing activities can provide practical starting points for future cooperation, subject to applicable compliance and risk considerations.

Ultimately, CCI India's role should extend beyond facilitating individual transactions. By building trusted networks, reliable knowledge systems and long term institutional relationships, CCI India can position itself as a strategic bridge between Indian industry and Sudan's emerging economic opportunities. The objective is to remain engaged and prepared today so that Indian businesses are well positioned to contribute to Sudan's recovery, reconstruction and sustainable private sector development tomorrow.

As Sudan gradually moves towards recovery, early and well structured engagement can provide Indian businesses with a better understanding of emerging needs and future opportunities. CCI India can play a catalytic role by bringing together industry, institutions and knowledge partners, ensuring that engagement is guided by market realities, responsible business practices and mutual priorities. This can create a strong foundation for deeper cooperation when conditions become more conducive to trade and investment.

This approach can help transform emerging opportunities into structured partnerships, while strengthening trust, knowledge exchange and long term commercial linkages between Indian and Sudanese stakeholders.

# THANK YOU

CCI India sincerely thanks Your Excellency for the warm hospitality and gracious interaction with our team. We greatly value the opportunity to discuss strengthening India-Sudan bilateral trade and economic relations and look forward to deepening cooperation, expanding business engagement, and creating new avenues for trade, investment, and mutually beneficial partnerships between the two countries.



# *India–Sudan: Partners in Progress, United by Opportunity.*

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